

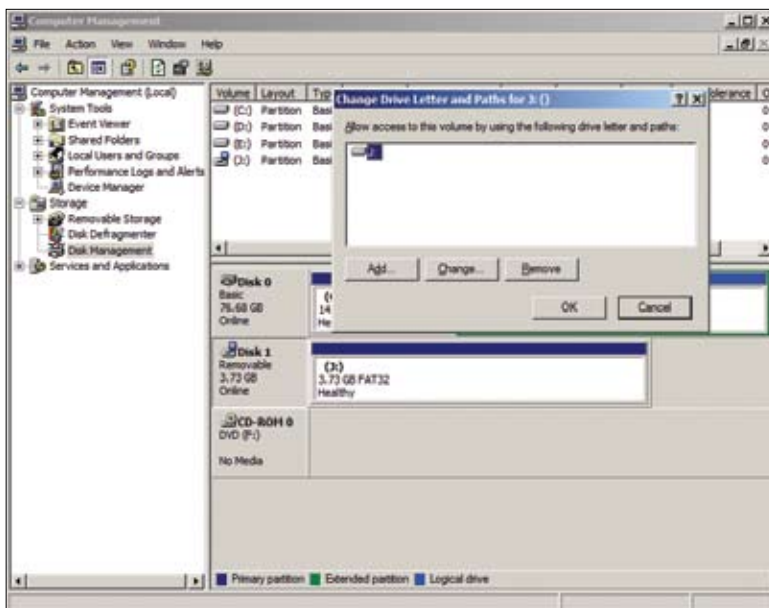
Thinkdigit's TECH Q&A EXPERTS

USB Drive Problems

Q I have a Transcend v20 pen drive. The file system on it has changed to RAW and the capacity now is 0 MB. I cannot access the drive or format it using the DOS application.

This software can't detect the pen drive, but the OS detects the pen drive and displays it as an USB device but it can't format.

I have tried formatting it, but it doesn't work. It could be detected in Windows, but it can't be accessed. In Linux, it can't even be detected. What should I do?



A By looking at the description you have provided, I see that you can see the pen drive in the Device Manager, without a drive letter assigned, so you are unable to format it. After connecting the drive to the USB port, right-click on My Computer > Manage > Disk Management. Find the USB disk under disk management. Assign a drive letter by right-clicking on it. After that, format it from there itself.

Radhakrishnan (TECH QNA Expert)

A I am not sure of any other methods since you have already tried most of the steps like using different operating systems and formats. If it is under warranty please get it replaced as the pen drive might be damaged.

Gopi (TECH QNA Expert)

Startup Problems

Q I have a Compaq laptop with Centrino processor, 2 GB RAM, 160 GB hard drive. My problem is that whenever I start my laptop, it does not start

instantaneously. However after two or three attempts, it starts. My operating system is Vista Home Basic.

A It could be due to many reasons. Check if the BIOS screen itself comes up or whether there is a delay. If BIOS screen comes up instantly but OS screen takes time, it could be due to a boot loader issue if you had multiple operating systems. Take backup of all your data and try an OS repair with the OS DVD.

Gopi (TECH QNA Expert)

Turbo C++ Crashes!

Q Recently I have assembled a PC with a Pentium D 3 GHz processor, a Zebronic NVIDIA 7150 chipset based motherboard, and 1 GB RAM. I have installed Window XP SP2, and all required software. Everything is running smoothly. When I installed Turbo C++, it is does not open. When I double-click the TC.exe from bin folder, a blank window opens for a fraction of a second and disappears, and an error message is displayed—

16 bit MS-DOS Subsystem

Turbo C++ IDE

The NTVDM CPU has encountered an illegal instruction. CS: dooo IP: 03e3 OP: ffeb05ea80

Choose 'Close' to terminate the application.

This is the problem and is there any solution for this? Please tell me what this message means. I am waiting for your suggestion.

A I am assuming that your Turbo C++ installation is not corrupt. The problem is due to a compatibility issue. Go to C:\tc\bin and right click on tc.exe and click on Properties. After the properties window is displayed, click on Compatibility and Check the checkbox for Run this program in compatibility mode and select "Windows 98". This will solve the problem. If that doesn't work, your installation is most likely corrupt.

Danish (TECH QNA Expert)

Can I Make My Drive Portable?

Q My question is that I have an 80GB 7200 RPM SATA Seagate hard disk. I want to use it as a portable USB HDD, please tell me how I can do this. Please also tell me what I need to do this.

A Yes of course you can do it. You should buy USB HDD case that is suitable for it. Power and SATA connectors will be supplied with that case. You have to place your SATA hard disk in it and connect the cables and you're done. It can be easily available in computer shops at major cities. The price for such cases starts from Rs 400 to Rs 900 only.

N.Vinay Kumar (TECH QNA Expert)